Docker Machine is a command-line tool that can create Docker-ready instances for us. It uses the adapter pattern, providing a number of different *drivers*[1] capable of creating instances on different platforms. This means we can use similar commands to create instances, whether they're virtual instances running on our local machine or cloud-based infrastructure.

In this chapter, we're going to use VirtualBox to run our local instances. If you don't already have it and want to follow along, you'll have to install it. VirtualBox's documentation[2] is pretty comprehensive. Go to the installation section[3] and follow the instructions for whichever platform you're running. Meet me back here when you're done.

Windows 10: Hyper-V or VirtualBox?



If you installed Docker via Docker for Windows—which relies on Microsoft *Hyper-V*— you will need to use Hyper-V instead of VirtualBox for local virtualization. Make sure you have Hyper-V set up correctly to work with Docker Machine as per Docker's example.[4]

Unlike VirtualBox users, you will need to use a command like this to create a machine with Hyper-V:

```
$ docker-machine create \
    --driver hyperv \
    --hyperv-virtual-switch "myswitch" \
    local-vm-1
```

All set? Great.

Now that you have VirtualBox running, we can create a new virtual machine for running our app:

```
$ docker-machine create --driver virtualbox local-vm-1
Running pre-create checks...
Creating machine...
(local-vm-1) Copying /Users/rob/.docker/machine/cache/boot2docker.iso to
/Users/rob/.docker/machine/machines/local-vm-1/boot2docker.iso...
(local-vm-1) Creating VirtualBox VM...
(local-vm-1) Creating SSH key...
(local-vm-1) Starting the VM...
(local-vm-1) Check network to re-create if needed...
(local-vm-1) Waiting for an IP...
Waiting for machine to be running, this may take a few minutes...
```

1. https://docs.docker.com/machine/drivers/
2. https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/
3. https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/ch02.html
4. docs.docker.com/machine/drivers/hyper-v/#example